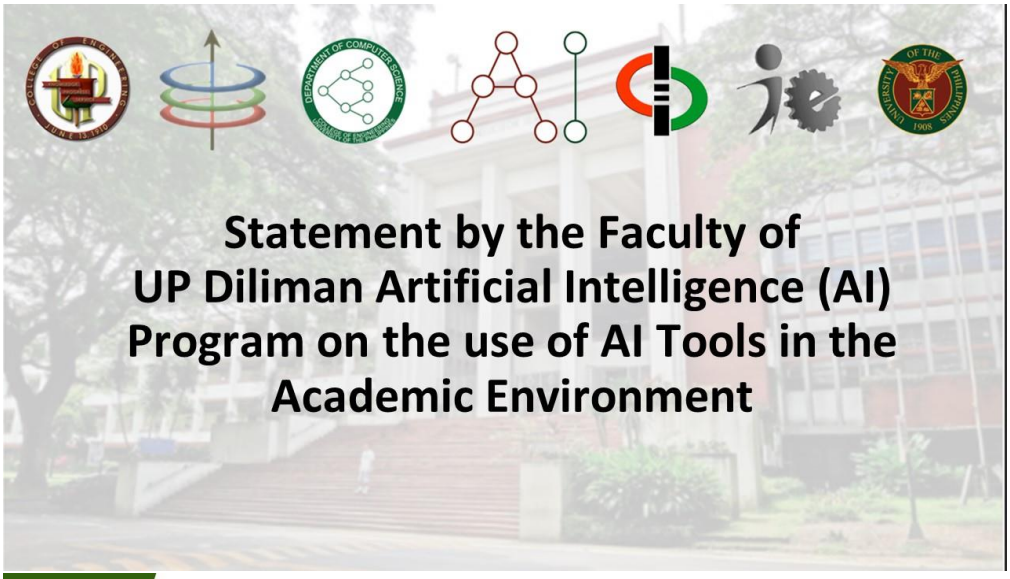


Statement by the Faculty of UP Diliman Artificial Intelligence (AI) Program on the use of AI Tools in the Academic Environment

It has come to our attention about the alleged instances of academic requirements submitted by students of the University that were created by Large Language Model (LLM) systems, such as ChatGPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformers). LLMs answer queries by generating useful texts containing concepts and ideas learned from the large body of information available on the Internet. The professor verified the students' submission with two AI detector systems that led to the conclusion that the work was most likely written by an AI. This experience led to extensive discussions in social media platforms, wherein students have become concerned that faculty members might "weaponize" these AI detector systems to claim academic dishonesty against original outputs. The concern is not limited to LLMs but also equally applicable to other types of AI tools for graphic designs (e.g. Stability AI and MidJourney), content generators (e.g. Jasper AI), automatic computer programs generation (e.g. CoPilot and Ghostwriter), voice mimicry (e.g. VALL-E) and synthetic human videos (e.g. Synthesia AI).

The faculty of UPD AI program condemns the outputs of these systems to misrepresent as valid scholarly works. Manuscripts, graphic designs, videos, computer programs and other academic requirements must be solely created by the student or group of students as required by the instructor of the course. However, the use of AI tools to enhance and facilitate the students' learning should be encouraged. AI tools can improve our writing skills, provide rapid visualization and prototyping of our ideas, enable quick access to a large body of knowledge, and demonstrate to us how to build better computer programs.

In many universities around the world, these AI tools rose to the top of their academic agenda. Task forces and open forum discussions have been established to provide guidance on how to deal with this disruptive innovation. It would be frivolous to ban AI tools in our University computer networks. It is recommended that we utilize this technology in our academic life to further improve our learning productivity.

With this background, the faculty of UPD AI program recommends the University to:

1. Conduct open forum discussions and colloquia to discuss AI tools and their implications on academic matters;
2. Revisit the University definition of academic integrity to include AI tools in the generation of academic requirements;
3. Educate students on the proper use of AI tools and embed these materials in our courses; and
4. Improve the academic requirements to include more in-depth critical thinking, scholarly discourse, and sound judgment.

"Technology will never replace great teachers, but technology in the hands of great teachers is transformational" – George Couros